# Xavier Tierney

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## EDUCATION

**London School of Economics** 2021–present
PhD in Economics, expected 2027

**London School of Economics** 2023
MRes in Economics, with Distinction

**London School of Economics** 2021
MSc in Econometrics and Mathematical Economics, with Distinction

**University of Oxford, Balliol College** 2018
BA in Physics and Philosophy, First Class Honours

## RESEARCH FIELDS

**Primary:** Urban **Secondary:** Development, Labour

## JOB MARKET PAPER

**Lopsided Cities: The costs of lopsided jobs distributions, and place-based policy responses**

Many cities have lopsided employment distributions: the center of business is tied to one side of the city, while residences sprawl out in the other direction. This means average distances to employment are further than they would be in a symmetric city – increasing commute times. In this paper, I investigate the costs of such lopsidedness, its impact on inequality and possible policy responses. Calibrating a quantitative urban model to Sydney, I show that a counterfactual city with a more centralised employment hub has 11% higher output and 2.5% higher worker welfare, suggesting the costs of the existing jobs distribution are substantial. I then investigate the effects of a government policy to try to directly alter this distribution: the 2018-2022 shift of over 10,000 government jobs to a more central location in Sydney. Using a synthetic control method, I find that land values surrounding the new offices increased substantially compared to comparable locations, and that new private office constructions increased by over 1 billion AUD – consistent with space for 7,000 new private workers. Using the model to consider general equilibrium effects of the public sector jobs move, I show these significant local effects are consistent with small effects for the city as a whole: total output falls slightly along with welfare of high skill workers due to decentralisation out of the CBD, but welfare of low skill workers marginally increases.

## WORK IN PROGRESS

**The Consequences of Unequal Home Ties** (with Josiah Hickson)

**Fake Meats and Directed Technical Change**

## TEACHING

**PP440 Micro and Macro Economics for Public Policy (graduate), LSE** 2024/25, 2025/26
Teaching assistant for Luis Garicano and Ethan Ilzetzki

**EC1A5 Microeconomics I (undergraduate), LSE** 2023/24
Teaching assistant for Alan Manning

**EC1B5 Macroeconomics I (undergraduate), LSE** 2022/23, 2023/24
Teaching assistant for Rachel Ngai and Keyu Jin

**Awards:** LSE Excellence in Education Award (2025); Economics Department teaching bonus award (2023, 2024)

## RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

**Research Assistant to Professor Gharad Bryan, LSE** 2024

**Research Assistant to Professors Oriana Bandiera and Robin Burgess, LSE** 2019–2020

**Research Scholar, Future of Humanity Institute, University of Oxford** 2018–2019
Salaried research fellowship. Worked with the Centre for the Governance of AI on market concentration, the economics of protectionism and trends in technological progress

**Research Assistant to Professor Armin Reichold, Particle Physics, University of Oxford** 2018

## HONOURS AND AWARDS

**LSE Job Market Fund** 2026–2027
**LSE Excellence in Education Award** 2025
**LSE Economics Department teaching bonus award** 2023, 2024
**LSE PhD Scholarship** 2021–2026
**Theobald Scholarship, Balliol College** 2017

## PROFESSIONAL ACTIVITIES

**Referee:** *Economica*
**Service:** Co-organiser, Development Economics Research Breakfast, LSE
**Mentoring:** Applicant Mentor Programme for PhD applicants from underrepresented backgrounds

## ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

**Programming:** R, MATLAB, Python, Stata, QGIS, LaTeX
**Citizenship and residency:** Australia, the Netherlands (citizen); UK settled status

## REFERENCES

**Daniel Sturm**
Professor of Economics
London School of Economics
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**Gharad Bryan**
Associate Professor of Economics
London School of Economics
g.t.bryan@lse.ac.uk

**Henry Overman**
Professor of Economic Geography
London School of Economics
h.g.overman@lse.ac.uk